

Pentagon was told to cease polygraphs

White House directed Hegseth’s team to stop tests after complaint

BY DAN LAMOTHE AND ELLEN NAKASHIMA

Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth’s use of polygraph tests to search for people leaking information to the news media was stopped at the direction of the White House after a senior adviser to Hegseth raised alarm to senior officials there about being targeted, U.S. officials and others familiar with the matter said.

The adviser, Patrick Weaver, complained to White House officials this spring with concerns that he could soon be directed by Hegseth or another member of his team to submit to a polygraph test, the people familiar with the matter said. The possibility angered Weaver, an immigration hawk seen within the administration as a loyal foot soldier to President Donald Trump and associate of White House Deputy Chief of Staff Stephen Miller, officials said, speaking on the condition of anonymity out of concerns for reprisal from the Trump administration.

The White House intervention, which has not previously been reported, came in the form of a phone call by an individual close to the administration after Hegseth’s team had begun administering polygraph tests to people around the defense secretary in April, according to people familiar with the matter, who declined to identify the individual.

Before they were stopped, multiple tests were carried out over several weeks with approval by Hegseth and advice from Tim Parlatore, who has served as both Hegseth’s private attorney and a part-time military aide on his staff.

Weaver had previously served SEE HEGSETH ON A24

DOGE deploys AI with goal of axing 100,000 federal rules

BY HANNAH NATANSON, JEFF STEIN, DAN DIAMOND AND RACHEL SIEGEL

The U.S. DOGE Service is using a new artificial intelligence tool to slash federal regulations, with the goal of eliminating half of Washington’s regulatory mandates by the first anniversary of President Donald Trump’s inauguration, according to documents obtained by The Washington Post and four government officials familiar with the plans.

The tool, called the “DOGE AI Deregulation Decision Tool,” is supposed to analyze roughly 200,000 federal regulations to determine which can be eliminated because they are no longer required by law, according to a PowerPoint presentation obtained by The Post that is dated July 1 and outlines DOGE’s plans. Roughly 100,000 of those rules would be deemed worthy of trimming, the PowerPoint estimates — mostly through the automated tool with some staff feedback. The PowerPoint also suggests the AI tool will save the United States trillions of dollars by reducing compliance SEE DOGE ON A24

Musk’s Epstein prelude: Former “first buddy” stoked a scandal. **A11**

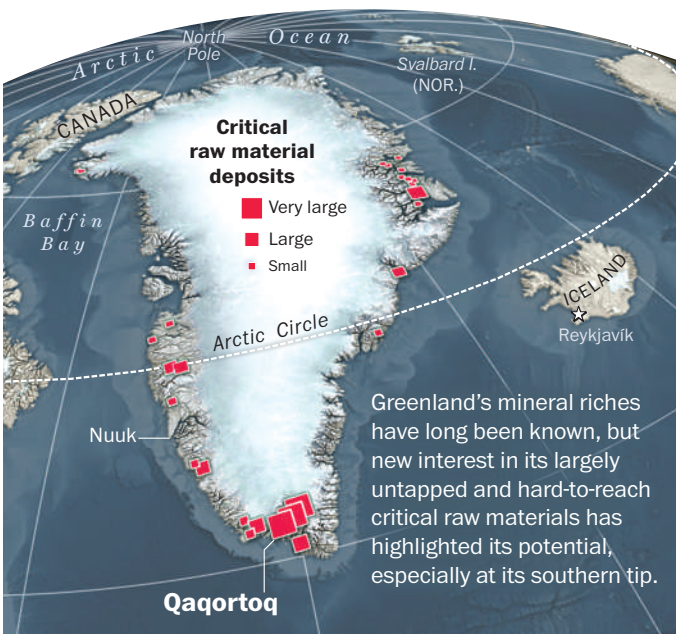
Trump covets rare earth metals and wants the U.S. to ‘get’ Greenland. But challenges await anyone trying to mine there.



JULIETTE PAVY/HORS FORMAT/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

A mineral wealth that’s hard to tap

BY WILLIAM BOOTH AND LARIS KARKLIS IN QAQORTOQ, GREENLAND



mark.

Greenland wants to be a mining nation. But it’s not much of one — not yet.

There are deposits of diamonds, graphite, lithium, copper, nickel, gallium, plus those rare earths with the sci-fi names — like dysprosium, neodymium and terbium.

A government-backed ruby mine here went bust. A long-running gold operation was open, then closed, and is now trying to reopen to capture a near-historic peak in the market. Greenland banned uranium mining in 2021; it is enmeshed in a billion-dollar lawsuit over the moratorium.

Companies have spent years prospecting, but the projects are seldom launched, because the markets are too soft or the costs too steep, to break ground in a frozen, roadless wilderness SEE GREENLAND ON A14

A fishing boat travels in a fjord near the proposed Tanbreez mine. To extract the minerals there, the mine’s owners will have to start from nothing and build an open pit quarry, roads, a processing plant and worker housing.

A pilot mourns air death of son who also took to the skies

Father of first officer who died at National Airport has flown both types of craft in Jan. 29 crash

BY RACHEL WEINER

While other kids had posters of movie stars or rock bands on their walls, Tim Lilley covered his with pictures of aircraft. He took his first flying lesson at age 13, got a private piloting license at 17, joined Army flight training at 19. He started out flying Black Hawks, then made a career in the cockpit of choppers and planes.

So on the evening of Jan. 29, as he saw news that an Army helicopter had collided with a passenger plane over D.C., he was struck by the enormity of the disaster. Tim reached out to someone else who would understand: his son Sam, who followed in his footsteps and became a pilot for PSA Airlines. Sam didn’t respond. Tim realized the plane that had plunged into the Potomac was a PSA jet. After a series of frantic calls to family he learned that he had just watched on television the death of his youngest son, the first officer on the flight.

SEE CRASH ON A6



STEPHEN B. MORTON/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Tim Lilley, in his Savannah, Georgia, home eyeing papers tied to the crash, is using experience from having flown both types of aircraft — and on both of their routes — to help avert a similar disaster.

In frayed Gaza, aid airdrops take hold

ISRAELI FOOD EFFORT DECRIED AS SCANT

Action comes amid rising starvation deaths, scorn

BY GERRY SHIH AND KATHARINE HOURELD

JERUSALEM — Israel has begun to airdrop food into Gaza, Israel said on Saturday, as deaths from starvation in the besieged enclave spread this past week and international criticism of Israel’s restrictions on aid reached a crescendo.

The Israeli military said seven pallets of flour, sugar and canned goods — which appeared to be less than a truckload of food — was dropped Saturday night after a meeting led by Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu and senior aides. Israeli troops were expected to pause fighting on Sunday to allow for food distribution and assist U.N. agencies in their aid delivery effort, the military said, and Israel will also turn on electricity to Gaza’s only functioning water desalination plant.

Israel shut the plant in March, depriving Gaza of the ability to make its own potable water.

Aid agencies on Saturday described the airdrops as an inadequate response and an Israeli attempt to whitewash a policy of deliberate starvation. The Israel Defense Forces said Saturday that the airdrops and other measures were “aimed at improving the humanitarian response in the Gaza Strip, and to refute the false claim of deliberate starvation in the Gaza Strip.”

An Israeli military official acknowledged last week to reporters that Gaza was facing a “lack of food security” but denied there was famine.

Still, Israel’s moves amounted SEE AID ON A18

Quiet Harvard president leads school’s fight against Trump

BY JOANNA SLATER AND SUSAN SVRLUGA

CAMBRIDGE, MASS. — On a sunny Friday last year, Alan Garber stepped up to a microphone to address thousands of Harvard University alumni at an annual reunion event. Suddenly, a woman walked toward the then-interim president and poured a tube of yellowish dust all over his head.

Drew Gilpin Faust, a former Harvard president, was sitting in the front row next to Garber’s wife. She remembers feeling terrified for him.

But Garber brushed himself off — the dust turned out to be glitter thrown by an animal rights activist — and said he hoped Harvard would always be a place where “free speech continues to thrive.”

“It was unbelievable,” Faust said. “He just soldiered on.”

Garber, now president of Harvard, will need all his reserves of equanimity — and his commitment to a range of viewpoints on campus — as he leads the nation’s oldest private university SEE GARBER ON A8

Columbia: Some worry monitor will hurt academic freedom. **A9**

SPORTS

A three-sport H.S. career put CC Sabathia on a path to Cooperstown. **B1**

BUSINESS

Norway, Europe’s top oil producer, embraces a carbon-capture plan. **B9**



ARTS & STYLE

As a “Happy Gilmore” sequel drops, a reporter scores other golf films.

METRO

Blues Alley turns 60 with swing, soul — and a fight to survive. **B17**



TRAVEL

A daughter photographs her parents at the dawn of their travel era.

BOOK WORLD

In “Pan,” youth unfolds in a boy who thinks he’s possessed by a god.

COMICS.....INSERT
OBTUARIES.....B21
OPINION PAGES.....A20
WORLD NEWS.....A13

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The Washington Post / Year 148, No. 54290

